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## File Case #4

**Case ID:** 92A **Case Title:** The "Ghost Fortune" Case **Date:** February 4, 2019 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

**Crime Summary:** **Ricardo Valbuena**, the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) of the successful family business "**Valbuena & Sons**," disappeared without a trace. A subsequent audit revealed an **embezzlement of over 10 million euros** over three years. It is believed the disappearance was planned, and he fled the country with the money.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The embezzlement was carried out through a complex network of **shell corporations** registered in tax havens. Valbuena created **fake invoices** for "consulting services" to these companies, which he then authorized himself. The money was moved through **multiple accounts** to make tracking difficult.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Ricardo Valbuena.**
- **Victim:** The company "Valbuena & Sons" and his family.

### Key Evidence:

- Forensic accounting reports detailing the **money trail**.
- An **encrypted hard drive** found in his office, which could not be decrypted.
- Valbuena's car was found in the **long-stay airport parking lot**. Inside, there was a **partially burned passport** in his name.
- There are **no records** of Ricardo Valbuena boarding any commercial flight that day or the days following.

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the vehicle showed no signs of violence. The **burned passport** was interpreted as an attempt to make people believe he had been the victim of a crime to buy time. Experts believe he likely used a **false identity** and traveled on a private flight or by sea.

**Resolution:** The case remains unsolved. Despite an international arrest warrant, **Ricardo Valbuena was never located**. The money was not recovered. The leading theory is that he is living in a non-extradition country under a new identity.